



CLAUDE CODE PLAYBOOK

FOR GTM TEAMS

Built by **SalesCaptain**, runs on Claude



12

Playbooks

8

Pipeline
Steps

25

Workflows

5

GTM
Motions



Bill Stathopoulos

CEO & Co-Founder @ SalesCaptain

YOU WILL WALK AWAY WITH

- 
- 01** *What Claude Code actually is, and why GTM teams are adopting it right now*
 - 02** *A plain-English glossary of every term you need to know*
 - 03** *A 10-minute setup guide with zero technical background required*
 - 04** *CLAUDE.md templates for 5 different GTM motions*
 - 05** *The three building blocks: Tools, Playbooks, and Connections*
 - 06** *The ICP Avatar framework: how to build a playbook that makes every output sharper*
 - 07** *The 8-step outbound pipeline running from a single terminal*
 - 08** *A real cost breakdown: what Claude Code workflows actually cost per month*
 - 09** *Your First Win in 60 Minutes: five copy-paste prompts to run today*

YOU WILL WALK AWAY WITH

- 
- 10** *Which tool does what: Claude Code vs Clay vs n8n vs Make vs Zapier*
 - 11** *Use cases for every GTM role: SDR, AE, Marketing, RevOps, Customer Success*
 - 12** *How to write great prompts: the formula, worked example, and anti-patterns*
 - 13** *Email copy quality rules to give Claude before any campaign*
 - 14** *What NOT to automate, and a 6-question readiness checklist*
 - 15** *Honest limitations: what does not work yet and how to work around it*
 - 16** *A troubleshooting guide for the 6 most common failure modes*
 - 17** *A one-page command reference*
 - 18** *A 30-day action plan to go from zero to running campaigns*

Plain English Glossary

Every term you will encounter in this guide, explained simply.

Terminal: A black or white text window on your computer where you type instructions. Think of it as texting your computer directly, without clicking any buttons.

API: Application Programming Interface. A back door that lets two apps talk to each other automatically. When Claude Code "connects to Apollo," it means Claude is calling Apollo directly, with no manual clicking.

MCP (Model Context Protocol): A plug-in that connects Claude Code to a specific app, such as HubSpot, Slack, or Gmail. Think of it as a USB cable between Claude and your software.

Skill File: A plain-text document that teaches Claude how to run a specific GTM workflow, like a playbook for a new hire. You write it once, Claude follows it every time.

Context Window: How much information Claude can hold in mind at once during a session. Like short-term memory: the longer the session, the more it may start to forget earlier instructions.

CLAUDE.md: A special file in your project folder that Claude reads at the start of every session. It contains your ICP, your offer, and your preferences, so you never have to repeat yourself.

Waterfall Enrichment: A process where Claude tries the cheapest data source first to find an email address, then tries a second and third provider if the first one fails. This maximises coverage while minimising cost.

1. What Is Claude Code, and Why Does It Matter for GTM?

Let's clear up the biggest misconception first.

Claude Code is not a tool for developers or engineers. The word "code" in the name is misleading, and it is keeping GTM teams from one of the most powerful productivity tools available to them right now.

Claude Code is an AI agent, meaning a smart assistant that can take actions rather than just answer questions. It lives in a terminal on your computer. You talk to it in plain English. It connects to your tools, reads your files, calls APIs (back doors into other software), and executes workflows, all without you writing a single line of code.

The best way to think about it: imagine a brilliant new hire who never sleeps, never complains, has memorised every GTM playbook ever written, and can be plugged directly into Apollo, HubSpot, Instantly, Slack, and LinkedIn Ads at the same time.

For a B2B outbound team, this changes the economics of go-to-market completely. Tasks that used to take a full day, building a list, enriching contacts, writing copy, launching a campaign, can run in under 10 minutes.

What Claude Code does versus what it does not do

What Claude Code does	What Claude Code does NOT do
Connects directly to your tools via API	Replace your GTM strategy or judgment
Executes repeatable workflows automatically	Make decisions that require business context you have not given it
Remembers your ICP, offer, and copy frameworks across sessions	Work without clear inputs and outputs defined by you
Scores leads with precise Python logic, zero AI guesswork	Guarantee results without a quality GTM strategy behind it
Run the same workflow 100 times with the same quality each time	Replace human review for high-stakes communications

The one question that separates great results from average ones

The GTM teams getting extraordinary results are not the most technical. They are the ones who can answer three questions before they start any workflow:

1. What are my inputs? (a lead list, a CSV, a call transcript, a company domain)
2. What is my output? (a launched campaign, a scored list, a Slack alert, a CRM update)
3. What does "good" look like? (an example email, a scoring rubric, a quality threshold)

If you can answer all three, Claude Code can execute it. If you cannot describe what "done" looks like, no amount of AI will help.

EXAMPLE BRIEF: "Read our last 10 Fathom call recordings. Check each one against the BANT criteria in our scoring file. Flag any red flags with a direct quote from the transcript.
Post a summary to the #pipeline-review channel in Slack."

Inputs: call recordings. Output: Slack post. Quality signal: BANT criteria + quoted evidence.

2. Set Up in 10 Minutes

You do not need to know how to code. You need three things: VS Code (a free text editor), the Claude Code extension, and a Claude subscription (\$20 per month is enough to start).

Step-by-step installation

Step	Time	What to do
1	2 min	Google "VS Code download," install for your operating system (Mac or Windows), and open it.
2	1 min	Click the puzzle-piece icon on the left sidebar (Extensions). Search "Claude Code." Install the official Anthropic extension.
3	2 min	Click the Claude icon that appears. Choose "Claude AI Subscription." Log in with your Anthropic account. Restart VS Code.
4	2 min	Create a folder on your computer called "gtm-workspace." Open it in VS Code. Click Terminal in the top menu, then New Terminal. Type <code>claude</code> and press Enter.
5	Done	You will see a prompt appear. Type "Hello" and press Enter. If Claude responds, you are fully set up.

Your CLAUDE.md file: the single most important setup step

Create a plain-text file called CLAUDE.md in your project folder. Claude reads it automatically at the start of every session. This is your permanent GTM context layer, so you never have to re-explain your business.

What to include in your CLAUDE.md file:

WHO WE TARGET: {Your ICP}

WHAT WE SELL: [Your offer in one sentence]

OUR BEST PERFORMING EMAIL OPENER: [Paste an example]

SCORING CRITERIA: Tier 1 = ..., Tier 2 = ...

TOOLS WE USE: e.g. Apollo (API key in `.env`), Instantly (API key in `.env`), HubSpot (API key in `.env`)

DO NOT CONTACT: existing clients, competitors listed in `exclusions.csv`

Without CLAUDE.md --> Claude is a chatbot.

With CLAUDE.md --> Claude is a GTM engine that knows your business.

CLAUDE.md templates by GTM motion

Not all GTM teams run the same type of motion. Your CLAUDE.md should reflect how your team actually goes to market. Here are the key differences by motion type:

Motion type	What to emphasise in CLAUDE.md	Key signals to include
Outbound-led	ICP firmographics, tier scoring criteria, copy frameworks, exclusion list	Hiring, funding rounds, tech stack changes, competitor usage
Product-led (PLG)	Free-to-paid conversion criteria, usage signals that indicate expansion readiness, champion identification	Product usage milestones, team size growth inside the account, feature adoption patterns
Account-based (ABM)	Named account list, stakeholder map per account, multi-thread sequence logic	Executive changes, board announcements, strategic initiative signals
Founder-led	Founder's personal brand voice, warm network prioritisation rules, referral and intro request templates	LinkedIn connections, mutual contacts, conference attendance
Agency (done-for-you)	Client ICP per project folder, per-client exclusion lists, client-specific copy tone and offer	Separate project folders per client, each with their own CLAUDE.md

The 4 operating modes

Claude Code has four ways of running. Choose the right one based on how much you trust the current workflow.

Mode	What it does	Use it when
Plan Mode	Claude thinks through the task and shows you a plan. Touches nothing.	Before any new workflow, every time
Auto-Accept Edits	Executes the plan step by step. Still asks before running system commands.	Once you have reviewed and approved the plan
Auto Mode	Runs fully, only blocking actions you have explicitly flagged.	Workflows you have tested and trust completely

Skip Permissions	Full autopilot, no confirmations at all. The name is intentional.	Isolated test environments only. Never on live data.
-------------------------	--	---

Switch between Plan Mode and Auto-Accept Edits by pressing Shift+Tab while Claude is running.

Your project folder structure

Folder or file	What it contains
CLAUDE.md	Your GTM brain: ICP, offer, scoring criteria, voice guidelines
/playbooks/	Skill files: plain-text playbooks that teach Claude specific workflows
/inputs/	Your raw data: company CSVs, contact lists, call transcripts
/outputs/	Everything Claude creates: scored lists, campaign files, generated copy
/templates/	Examples of your best emails, scoring rubrics, output formats
.env (hidden file)	Your API keys, stored securely and invisible in file browsers

Before you build anything: email infrastructure

Claude Code cannot fix a deliverability problem. If your sending infrastructure is not set up correctly, your campaigns will land in spam regardless of how good the copy is. Get this right first.

What to set up	Why it matters	How to do it
Separate sending domains	Keeps your main domain reputation clean if a campaign underperforms	Buy 2 to 3 domains that look like your brand (e.g. getsalescaptain.com, try-salescaptain.com). Never send cold outreach from your main domain.
SPF record	Tells receiving servers your sending domain is authorised	Add a TXT record to your domain DNS. Your sequencer (Instantly, Lemlist) will give you the exact record to paste.
DKIM record	Cryptographically signs your emails so they cannot be spoofed	Generated inside your email provider (Google Workspace or Microsoft 365). Add the provided TXT record to DNS.
DMARC record	Tells servers what to do if SPF or DKIM fail. Required by Google and	Add a TXT record: v=DMARC1; p=none;

	Microsoft for bulk senders.	rua=mailto:youremail@yourdomain.com. Start with p=none, tighten later.
Mailbox warmup	New inboxes with no history get flagged immediately. Warmup builds a reputation before you send.	Run warmup for a minimum of 2 to 3 weeks before sending any cold outreach. Most sequencers include a built-in warmup tool.
Daily send limits	Sending too much too fast is one of the fastest ways to get an inbox flagged	Start at 20 to 30 emails per inbox per day. Scale up by 5 to 10 per week once your domain shows a healthy reputation score.
Deliverability score check	A score below 80 out of 100 means your emails are likely going to spam before your campaign even starts	Run a weekly inbox placement test from inside your sequencer. Aim for 80 or above. Below 80, pause sending and investigate.

A note on what Claude Code can and cannot do here:

Claude Code can help you generate the correct DNS record values, check your domain configuration,

and monitor your deliverability score automatically each week.

It cannot repair a domain reputation that has already been damaged by over-sending.

Set the infrastructure up correctly once. Then let Claude Code monitor it for you.

Connecting your tools: the MCP config file

MCP (Model Context Protocol) connections turn Claude Code from a smart assistant into a GTM operator. Once a tool is connected, Claude can read from it, write to it, and trigger actions inside it, all from a single session.

Add connections to a file at `.claude/settings.json` in your project folder:

```
{
  "mcpServers": {
    "instantly-main": {
      "type": "http",
      "url": "https://mcp.instantly.ai/mcp/YOUR_API_KEY_HERE"
    },
    "apollo": {
      "type": "http",
      "url": "https://mcp.apollo.io/mcp/YOUR_API_KEY_HERE"
    }
  }
}
```

```
}  
}  
}
```

Global (all projects): ~/.claude/settings.json

Project-specific: .claude/settings.json in your project root

Agency teams: one named entry per client account (e.g. instantly-client-acme)

What does this actually cost? Monthly budget reality check

The most common question before committing. Here is what running Claude Code for outbound actually costs at realistic usage levels.

Workflow	Claude API cost	Third-party APIs	Monthly at 4x/week
Score 200 companies against ICP	~\$0.03	None (uses your data)	~\$0.50
Enrich 100 contacts (waterfall)	~\$0.05	\$5 to \$15 (enrichment credits)	\$20 to \$60
Generate 3-step sequences for 50 contacts	~\$0.08	None	~\$1.30
Personalise 100 icebreakers (with Perplexity)	~\$0.40	\$5 to \$10 (Perplexity API)	\$20 to \$40
Full campaign build: source, score, enrich, copy, launch	~\$0.80	\$15 to \$30	\$60 to \$120
Weekly campaign report (pull, analyse, format)	~\$0.10	None	~\$1.60

Total monthly cost for a team running 2 to 4 campaigns in parallel: \$50 to \$150.

The Claude subscription (\$20/month) covers the AI cost comfortably.

The variable cost is third-party enrichment and research APIs.

Compare that to a full-time SDR (\$4,000 to \$7,000/month) doing the same work manually.

Your First Win in 60 Minutes

Before you read anything else, run this. It works with zero setup beyond your Claude subscription and one CSV of companies. Every step below is a copy-paste prompt.

What you will have at the end:

A scored and tiered company list

Decision-maker contacts identified

A 3-step email sequence ready to load into your sequencer

Total time: 45 to 60 minutes

Total cost: under \$1

Step	Action	Paste this into Claude Code
1	Create your CLAUDE.md	<i>"Create a CLAUDE.md file in this folder. My company is [your company]. I sell [your product] to [your ICP: role, company size, industry]. My best-performing email subject line is [paste it]. My main competitor is [competitor name]. Flag any company that is a direct competitor or a current customer."</i>
2	Score your company list	<i>"I have a CSV of companies in /inputs/companies.csv. Score each company against the ICP in CLAUDE.md. Give each a score from 0 to 100 and assign a tier: Tier 1 (80+), Tier 2 (50 to 79), Tier 3 (below 50). Add a column explaining the score in one sentence. Save the output to /outputs/scored-companies.csv."</i>
3	Find decision-makers	<i>"For each Tier 1 company in /outputs/scored-companies.csv, use the Apollo API to find the [VP Sales / Head of Marketing / your target title]. Save first name, last name, title, company, and LinkedIn URL to /outputs/contacts.csv."</i>
4	Write the sequences	<i>"For each contact in /outputs/contacts.csv, write a 3-step cold email sequence. Step 1: 70 words, problem-focused, no company intro. Step 2: 50 words, different angle, social proof if possible. Step 3: 35 words, give them an easy out. Save to /outputs/sequences.csv with one column per step."</i>
5	Review and load	<i>"Show me the 3 best sequences from /outputs/sequences.csv and explain why you chose them. Flag any that break the copy rules: over 80 words in step 1, more than one CTA, or opening with a company name."</i>

Once you have reviewed and approved the sequences, load them manually into your sequencer.

DO NOT automate the final send step until you have reviewed at least one full batch.

3. How It Works: Tools, Playbooks, and Connections

Claude Code has three layers. Most teams use only the first. All three together is where the 🚀 happens.

Layer 1: Tools: What Claude Can Do Out of the Box

Tools are Claude Code's built-in abilities. No setup needed. From the moment you open Claude, it can already do all of this:

Built-in tool	What it means for your GTM work
Read and write files	Process your lead CSVs, save campaign outputs, manage data files automatically
Run code (Python, JavaScript)	Score leads with exact logic, clean data, build enrichment waterfalls -- no AI guesswork
Search the web	Research companies in real time, check recent news, verify contact details
Execute terminal commands	Trigger automations, schedule jobs, run scripts while you focus elsewhere
Manage code repositories	Store your playbooks and share GTM workflows across your whole team

Layer 2: Playbooks: Your GTM Methodology in a File

A playbook is a plain-text file that teaches Claude how to approach a specific GTM workflow. Write it once in plain English. Claude follows it every time, same quality, every run. The more context you give it, the less you repeat yourself.

12 playbooks every GTM team should build first

Playbook	What it teaches Claude	Who benefits	Feeds into
FOUNDATION -- build these first, everything else depends on them			
ICP Profile	Full description of your ideal customer: size, industry, signals, pain points, and exclusions	Everyone	All other playbooks
Brand Voice	Extracts writing patterns from your best emails and posts into a reusable voice guide	Marketing , founders	All content
Segment-to-Message Mapper	Maps each ICP segment (by industry, size, or role) to the right offer angle, pain point,	SDR, AE, Marketing	All outreach

	and proof point. Claude loads the right variant automatically per prospect.		
PROSPECTING -- finding and qualifying the right people			
Lead Scorer	Scores companies using Python rules (not AI), zero risk of hallucination. Outputs clean Tier 1, 2, and 3 lists.	RevOps	Lead routing, all campaigns
Outreach Writer	Finds a timely signal per prospect and writes personalised first lines using the correct segment angle from your Segment-to-Message Mapper	SDR, AE	Email sequences
CONVERSION -- moving prospects from interest to meeting to close			
Offer Testing	Runs 3 to 5 offer angles as separate mini-campaigns, tracks which angle gets positive replies by segment, flags the winner after a defined sample size. Your A/B testing infrastructure.	SDR, Marketing, founders	Email Frameworks, campaigns
Email Frameworks	Your best-performing email structures so Claude always writes in a proven format. Includes routing logic: awareness-led angles for cold or low-signal contacts, direct response angles for warm or high-intent contacts. Updated automatically by the Campaign Feedback Loop play.	SDR, Marketing	All campaigns
Objection Handler	A library of the 7 to 10 most common cold outreach objections with proven responses to each. Used to write pre-emptive follow-up sequences and draft replies to inbound responses.	SDR, AE	Follow-up sequences
Copy Stress-Test	Describe your target buyer as a persona. Claude reads your email draft as that person and flags what would make them delete it, what would make them reply, and what sounds generic. Run this before any campaign goes live.	SDR, Marketing, founders	Email Frameworks, Offer Testing
INTELLIGENCE -- context that makes every interaction sharper			
Social Proof Matcher	A structured library of results and case studies mapped by client type, industry, and pain point. Claude automatically pulls the most relevant proof point for each prospect.	AE, Marketing	Outreach Writer, Meeting Prep
Meeting Prep	One-page brief before every call: company context, stakeholder map, account history, smart questions, and likely objections	AE, CS	CRM notes

Call Debrief	Reads call transcript, scores BANT, flags red flags with direct quotes, drafts CRM update for approval	AE, Manager	Pipeline review, Follow-up
--------------	--	-------------	----------------------------

The ICP Avatar: the most important playbook you will ever build

Most ICPs are useless.

They describe a company type but say nothing about why someone buys today, what language they use to describe their problem, or what objections they will raise on a call. Claude Code needs all of that.

The framework that works: the 3-level pain hierarchy. Every real buyer has three layers of pain. Generic copy hits the surface. Copy that converts goes deeper.

Pain level	What it is	Example (for a sales ops tool)
Level 1: Surface pain	The symptom they describe when asked "what is the problem?"	"Our reporting takes too long and the numbers are never accurate."
Level 2: Operational pain	The downstream business cost that the surface pain is causing	"We are making territory and quota decisions on stale data and missing forecast calls."
Level 3: Identity-level pain	What this says about them as a professional. This is the real buy trigger.	"I look incompetent in front of the board every time I present pipeline numbers that get revised the next day."

Rule: every phrase in your ICP avatar must come from an exact customer quote.

"They struggle with follow-up" is analysis. Reject it.

"Our follow-up is a mess" is a quote. Keep it.

Sources to use: call transcripts, deal notes, G2/Capterra reviews, lost deal notes, onboarding calls.

Claude can extract and organise all of these for you if you paste the raw transcripts.

Layer 3: Connections: Claude Talking to Your Tools

Connections (sometimes called MCP connections) are plug-ins that link Claude Code directly to your existing software.

Once connected, Claude can read from and write to these tools without you logging in or clicking anything.

Connection	What it links Claude to	GTM use case
Apollo	275M+ contacts and company database	Source leads, find ICP contacts, enrich companies
HubSpot or Salesforce	Your CRM: contacts, deals, activities, pipelines	Update deal stages, log call notes, create contacts automatically
Instantly or Lemlist	Your email sequencer: campaigns, leads, analytics	Create campaigns, push leads, pull reply data
Google Workspace	Gmail, Google Docs, Google Sheets, Drive	Report replies, create docs, manage data in Sheets
Slack	Your team messaging platform	Real-time reply alerts, pipeline digests, SDR notifications
LinkedIn Ads	LinkedIn campaign manager	Build and update ad campaigns at scale without opening the platform

4. The 8-Step Outbound Campaign Pipeline

The end-to-end outbound workflow, running from a single terminal.

Each step feeds the next automatically.

#	Stage	What Claude Code does: and why it matters for your pipeline
1	Detect Signals	Monitors job postings, funding rounds, tech stack changes, LinkedIn post engagement, and website visitors. Flags companies in your ICP that are in active buying mode right now, not just sitting in a static list.
2	Score and Tier	Uses Python code (not AI) to score every company against your criteria: size, industry, funding, revenue, tech stack. No AI guesswork on this step, it is pure logic. Outputs clean Tier 1, 2, and 3 lists.
3	Score Fit Fast	Before spending on enrichment: read each company's website, tech stack, and hiring pages. Reject bad-fit companies now. This step saves significant enrichment credit by filtering out companies that would fail your criteria anyway. Run this on Tier 1 companies only.
4	Find Decision-Makers	Pulls the right people from your data provider by job title: Head of Sales, VP Marketing, Head of Partnerships. 150+ contacts sourced in 90 seconds, saved to a file automatically.
5	Enrich Contacts (add Clay here)	Runs a waterfall enrichment: tries the cheapest email provider first, catches misses with a second and third pass. Adds phone numbers, LinkedIn URLs, company descriptions. All via API, zero manual work.
6	Generate Copy	Reads your email frameworks file and writes sequences in your best-performing structure. Adjusts opening lines by industry, seniority,

		and company tier. Auto-formats personalisation tags like first name and company name.
7	Push Campaign	Creates the campaign in your sequencer via API. Uploads all leads. Sets all sequences. Names and activates the campaign, without you touching the sequencer at all.
8	Analyse and Improve	Pulls campaign analytics each week. Identifies which copy, subject lines, and industries are generating replies. Updates your email frameworks file automatically. Every new campaign benefits from what just ran.

The API stack, one tool per function

What you need	Tools that work	What Claude does with them
Buying signals	Apollo, Trigify, Common Room, Bombora, LinkedIn	Detects hiring, funding, tech changes, social activity
Finding people	Apollo, RocketReach, Blitz API, Ocean.io	Searches for ICP contacts using natural language, no filters to set
Email enrichment	Prospero, LeadMagic, Findymail, Hunter	Waterfall approach: runs cheapest provider first, catches misses automatically
Web research	Firecrawl, Tavily, Serper API, Exa.ai	Researches companies, checks news, finds public data at scale
Sending outreach	Instantly, Lemlist, Smartlead, Heyreach	Creates campaigns, pushes leads, activates sequences via API
CRM updates	HubSpot, Salesforce, Close.com, Attio	Creates contacts, logs activities, updates deal stages
Scheduling agents	Railway, GitHub Actions, Claude /loop command	Runs workflows every hour, day, or week without keeping your laptop open

5. Which Tool for What? The GTM Automation Stack

Clay, n8n, Make, Zapier, Claude Code, these are not competitors (fully). They are different layers of the automation and workflows stack. Using them correctly together is what separates teams who automate 80% of their GTM from teams still doing it manually.

The full tool comparison

GTM AUTOMATION TOOLS (WHAT TO USE WHEN)					
CRITERIA	CLAUDE CODE <i>The Builder</i>	clay <i>The Enricher</i>	n8n <i>The Engine</i>	make <i>The Connector</i>	zapier <i>The glue</i>
Entry Price	\$20/MO	~\$167/MO	\$0	\$9/MO	\$19.99/MO
Cost at Scale	VERY LOW	HIGH	VERY LOW	MEDIUM	HIGH
Technical Level	● ● ● ●	● ● ● ●	● ● ● ●	● ● ● ●	● ● ● ●
Learning Curve	MEDIUM	MEDIUM	MEDIUM	MEDIUM	LOW
Runs 24/7 Without You	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓
Non-Technical Friendly	✗	✓	✗	✓	✓
Writes Its Own Code	✓	✗	✗	✗	✗
B2B Data Enrichment	✗	✓	✗	✗	✗
Connects Any API	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Native AI Integration	✓	✓	✓	✗	✗
Self-Hostable	✗	✗	✓	✗	✗
Maintenance Burden	LOW	LOW	HIGH	LOW	VERY LOW
Unique Power	Writes & runs its own code. Skills files = never rebuilds the same task twice.	Waterfall enrichment across 15+ providers. Best email find rate in the market.	Open-source + self-host = zero per-op cost. Full logic control. AI agent nodes built in.	Visual builder. 1,000+ integrations. Best value for mid-complexity automations	6,000+ integrations. Widest coverage. Every team member already knows it.
GTM Sweet Spot	Build scrapers, score lists, call any API, push to sequencers. Tasks that need a developer.	Enrich any list, waterfall emails, ICP scoring, populate campaign buckets.	Website visitor → enrich → qualify → push to campaign. Fully automated, no one touching it.	Webhook → Clay table → sequencer. Visual multi-step logic without writing code.	Form fill → CRM → Slack notify. Simple connective tissue only. Don't overcomplicate it.
Biggest Weakness	Context resets between sessions. Strategy still lives with you, it builds what you tell it to.	Credit costs spiral fast. Not an automation engine, needs a trigger to run.	Every API update = manual fix. Managing 20+ client instances needs a dedicated person.	Less flexible than n8n for complex logic. Hits limits at very high data volumes.	Very expensive at scale. Not built for complex GTM logic. Outgrown quickly.
Works Best With	  	   	  	   	   
HOW THEY WORK TOGETHER	builds the logic	enriches the data	runs it 24/7		handles the simple connective tissue
 Bill Stathopoulos CEO & Co-Founder @ salescaptain  SALES CAPTAIN					

The GTM automation stack: what each tool does and when to use it

Clay vs Claude Code: which one for your stage?



The right tool depends on your GTM stage

6. What Your Team Can Do With Claude Code

By role. Each workflow below is running in production today.

SDR / Business Development

Biggest time sink: building lists, writing copy, and setting up campaigns manually

1. Signal-triggered outbound: detect a hiring or funding signal, find the right contacts, write copy referencing the specific trigger, and launch the campaign in one command
2. LinkedIn post engagement: scrape everyone who liked or commented on a relevant post, qualify against ICP, find their email, push to a personalised sequence automatically
3. Job-change tracking: monitor your CRM contacts for job changes, find their new work email automatically, add to a re-engagement sequence with a relevant first line
4. Competitor evaluation targeting: identify companies actively comparing tools, generate comparison messaging, launch multichannel campaign
5. Backlink and influencer outreach: find writers covering your space, automate personalised outreach, get responses without any manual work

Account Executive / Sales

Biggest time sink: meeting prep, post-call admin, and manual CRM updates

1. Meeting prep brief: 5 minutes before any call, Claude generates a one-page brief covering company news, buying committee map, account history, smart questions, and likely objections
2. BANT call analysis: Claude reads the call transcript, scores Budget, Authority, Need, and Timeline, flags red flags with direct quotes, and drafts the CRM update for your approval
3. Recovery email after a tough call: Claude reads the transcript, checks recent company news, and writes a recovery email that addresses the specific objection raised in the meeting
4. Buying committee research: when a new company books a call, Claude automatically identifies all decision-makers and influencers and adds them to a LinkedIn awareness sequence before the meeting
5. Deal intelligence: cross-reference call transcripts with CRM data to surface which messages and proof points correlate with closed-won deals

Marketing

Biggest time sink: creating content, running ads, and turning engagement into pipeline

1. LinkedIn ad campaigns without touching the platform: fill a Google Sheet with targeting specs and creative references, and Claude builds the entire campaign via API including audiences, copy, and bidding
2. Content-to-pipeline: your team posts on LinkedIn, Claude scrapes all engagers, qualifies them against ICP, and routes qualified contacts to an outbound sequence automatically
3. SEO content pipeline: research trending topics, write posts in your brand voice, push to GitHub, deploy to your website, all in one session

4. Win-loss messaging analysis: pull all call transcripts from won and lost deals, identify which messages and themes correlate with wins, update your copy frameworks automatically
5. Event attendee outreach: pull attendee lists from LinkedIn events relevant to your ICP, enrich and qualify contacts, generate event-contextualised outreach
6. Mine calls into content: pull your call transcripts from the past month, Claude extracts the strongest objections, proof points, and buyer quotes, then generates LinkedIn post drafts, carousel outlines, and creative briefs for the next campaign. Sales calls become content that pre-sells the next buyer.

RevOps

Biggest time sink: data hygiene, pipeline reviews, and manual reporting

1. Pipeline forecast check: pull all CRM pipeline data, cross-reference activity logs, flag deals with no activity in 14 days or close dates moved more than twice, and give you a realistic commit number with evidence
2. Custom signal enrichment: define your specific buying signals (funding type, hiring pattern, tech stack change), run against your entire CRM, get a confidence score and source link for each match
3. Positive reply routing: when a prospect replies positively in your sequencer, Claude enriches their phone number and posts to Slack with name, company, reply text, and phone number ready for immediate call-back
4. Weekly pipeline digest: every Monday, Claude pulls all deal activity from the past week, summarises by rep, and posts to Slack with at-risk deals highlighted
5. Lead magnet follow-up: when someone downloads a lead magnet and enters your CRM, Claude enriches their company, qualifies them, and adds them to the relevant nurture or outbound sequence

Customer Success

Biggest time sink: account research, renewal prep, and stakeholder mapping

1. Champion departure response: when a champion's email bounces, Claude researches their replacement, pulls full account history, builds a stakeholder map, assesses churn risk, and drafts the first outreach
2. Renewal intelligence: 6 weeks before any renewal, Claude analyses product usage signals, financial health, leadership changes, and open support tickets, and flags at-risk accounts with evidence
3. QBR preparation: pull all call transcripts from an account, summarise sentiment over time, key wins, and open issues, and generate a QBR deck in your brand template
4. Health scoring: combine product usage, support ticket trends, call sentiment, and CRM activity into an automated weekly account health score

7. How to Write Great Prompts for GTM Work

The difference between a team getting great results and one getting nothing, is not the tools. It is how they brief Claude. Here is the formula.

The Golden Formula: Context, Task, Format

Element	What it means	Example
Context	Your role, the problem, any background Claude needs	"We sell to {ROLE} at B2B SaaS companies, {NUMBER} employees..."
Task	Exactly what you want Claude to do, specific not vague	"Find 100 companies that raised Series A in the last 90 days, score them against the criteria in scoring.md"
Format	How you want the output delivered	"Save as a CSV with columns: company, domain, tier, and reason for tier"
Edge cases	What to do when something goes wrong	"If an email cannot be found, mark the column as MISSING, do not skip the row"
Quality signal	An example of what good looks like	"Match the tone of the example email in /templates/best-performer.txt"

The GTM systems-building prompt template

"You are a GTM engineer working for [company description from CLAUDE.md].

Build a [workflow type] that:

- Takes [input description] as input
- Handles [edge case 1] by [specific action]
- Handles [edge case 2] by [specific action]
- Outputs [exact format]

Use the API keys in .env. Save all outputs to /outputs/.

Tell me if you need anything clarified before starting, then switch to plan mode."

Email copy quality rules to give Claude

When asking Claude to write cold email copy, include these rules explicitly in your prompt or add them to your Email Frameworks playbook. These are the non-negotiables that separate emails that get replies from emails that get deleted.

Rules to follow	What to eliminate
Step 1 email: 60 to 80 words maximum	Any sentence over 20 words
Open with a direct observation or question, never with your name or company	Words: synergize, leverage, best-in-class, innovative, revolutionary, solutions, empower
Structure: Problem, Insight, Offer, single low-friction CTA	Opening your email with your company name
Subject line: personalised question, pattern interrupt, or diagnostic statement	A calendar link in the first email
Follow-up email: 40 to 60 words, different angle from step 1	More than one CTA in any single email
Breakup email: 30 to 40 words maximum, give them an easy out	Any unfilled bracket placeholders like [company] or [name]

A complete worked example

Here is what a real Claude Code session looks like from start to output.

Your prompt: "I have a CSV of 200 SaaS companies in /inputs/companies.csv. Score them using the criteria in CLAUDE.md. Find the VP Sales or Head of Revenue at each Tier 1 company using Apollo. Enrich their emails using Findymail. Generate a 3-step email sequence for each contact using the frameworks in /playbooks/email-frameworks.md. Create the campaign in Instantly and name it Q2-Outbound-Wave1."

What Claude does next:

1. Reads your CLAUDE.md and scoring criteria
2. Runs a Python script to score and tier all 200 companies (no AI, pure logic)
3. Calls Apollo API to find VP Sales or Head of Revenue contacts at Tier 1 companies
4. Runs Findymail API to enrich email addresses for each contact
5. Reads your email frameworks file and generates sequences for each contact
6. Calls the Instantly API to create the campaign, upload leads, and set sequences
7. Reports back: "Tier 1 list: 48 companies. Contacts found: 44. Emails verified: 41. Campaign created and live."

Total time: under 10 minutes. Manual equivalent: 4 to 6 hours.

The 3 things that kill results

Mistake	What happens	The fix
Being vague ("do my outbound for me")	Claude guesses and produces generic output	Define inputs, outputs, and quality signal before you start
Running very long sessions without resetting	Claude starts to drift and forget earlier instructions	Use the 50/50 rule: do all hard thinking in the first half of a session. Type /clear at the halfway point.
Starting with your biggest, most complex workflow	It produces something off, you cannot tell why, and you give up	Start with something you know well, where you can immediately judge if the output is good
Not asking for a --dry-run mode	You burn API credits validating logic that could have been tested on mock data first	For any workflow that calls external APIs, ask Claude to build a --dry-run flag that uses sample data. Test the logic before spending.

Prompting anti-patterns: real bad prompts and why they fail

Reading bad examples is more memorable than reading good ones. These are the most common patterns that produce frustrating output.

The bad prompt	Why it fails	The better version
<i>"Help me with my outbound"</i>	No inputs, no outputs, no quality signal. Claude has to guess at everything.	"I have a CSV of 50 SaaS companies in /inputs/list.csv. Score them against the ICP in CLAUDE.md and output a Tier 1 / Tier 2 / Tier 3 breakdown to /outputs/scored.csv."
<i>"Write me some cold emails"</i>	No ICP, no offer, no tone guidance, no length rules. Output will be completely generic.	"Write 3 cold email variants for VP Sales at B2B SaaS companies 50 to 200 employees. Use the ICP in CLAUDE.md and the frameworks in /playbooks/email-frameworks.md. Step 1: max 75 words. Single CTA. No opener with my company name."
<i>"Make this better"</i>	Better by what standard? Claude will make random changes and you will not know what improved or why.	"Rewrite this email to get a higher reply rate. The current open rate is 28% but reply rate is 0.3%. The problem is probably the opener or the CTA. Test 3 alternative openers. Keep everything else the same."
<i>"Do everything automatically"</i>	No review step, no error handling. When something goes wrong	"Run the enrichment on all contacts. After each batch of 20, save to /outputs/enriched.csv and show me a

	mid-pipeline, you will not know until damage is done.	progress summary. Stop and ask me before pushing anything to the sequencer."
"Write an email about our product features"	Feature-led cold emails do not get replies. The prospect does not know or care about your features until they have a reason to.	"Write an email that opens with a problem this persona experiences, connects it to a concrete cost or consequence, and only introduces the product as a possible path to fixing that problem. No feature list."

8. What NOT to Automate (and a Readiness Checklist)

The framework: what to automate, what to keep manual, what to do as a hybrid

Use this before building any new workflow.

Automate	Keep Manual	Hybrid (AI drafts, human approves)
Lead scraping and list building	Replying to warm prospects	ICP definition: Claude drafts, you validate
Email enrichment and verification	Pricing and contract negotiation	Campaign copy: Claude writes, you approve
Pushing qualified leads to campaigns	Strategic account planning	Personalisation: Claude researches, you QC
Campaign performance reporting	Relationship building	Report interpretation: Claude surfaces data, you draw conclusions
CSV processing and data formatting	First outreach to warm referrals	Lead scoring: Claude runs the logic, you set the criteria
CRM updates after calls	Hiring and team decisions	Call debrief: Claude drafts the summary, you review before logging

Data security: what is safe to send to Claude

Generally safe to send	Keep local or anonymise first
Publicly available company information	Full customer contracts or NDAs
Lead lists with names, titles, and email addresses	Internal financial data or board materials
Call transcripts (check your call recording tool's terms)	Personal data outside the scope of your consent agreements
Campaign copy and email templates	Passwords or sensitive credentials (use .env files for API keys)
Scoring criteria and qualification frameworks	Employee personal data unrelated to the GTM workflow

Note: Anthropic does not use Claude API inputs to train its models by default. If you are using the Claude.ai chat interface rather than the API, review the current data usage policy at anthropic.com/legal.

Is your workflow ready to automate? A quick checklist

Before you build any new Claude Code workflow, run through these questions. If you cannot answer yes to all of them, spend more time defining the workflow manually first.

#	Readiness question
1	Can you describe the exact inputs? (file name, format, source)
2	Can you describe the exact output? (format, columns, where it goes)
3	Do you have an example of a high-quality output you can show Claude?
4	Have you done this workflow manually at least once? (so you can evaluate the output)
5	Do you know what "wrong" looks like so you can catch errors early?
6	Is there a human review step built in before anything goes live or is sent?

What does not work yet: honest limitations

Runs per session, not continuously in the background. Claude Code cannot monitor your inbox continuously or fire alerts

when reply rates drop. For real-time monitoring, trigger sessions via n8n, Zapier, or a cron job.

No memory between sessions. Claude starts fresh every time. Your CLAUDE.md and playbook files are your persistent memory. Write decisions into them, not just into the chat.

Multi-step pipelines break mid-way. Add checkpoint saves after every batch of 50 leads.

Prompt: "after every 50 contacts, save progress to /outputs/checkpoint.csv."

Rate limits at scale. For 1,000+ lead runs, specify: "add a 1-second delay between API calls and process in chunks of 50 with error logging per chunk."

Context rot in long sessions. After ~2 hours, Claude can drift. Use /clear at the midpoint.

Do all the hard thinking in the first half of a session.

Ambiguous briefs produce bad outputs (garbage). If you cannot describe what done looks like, no amount of AI helps. Define inputs, outputs, and quality signal before starting.

When things go wrong: troubleshooting guide

Claude Code will produce bad output at some point. Here is how to diagnose and fix the most common issues quickly.

Symptom	Most likely cause	What to do
Output is generic, does not match your brand	CLAUDE.md is missing or not specific enough	Open CLAUDE.md and add: your three best-performing email examples, your exact tone description, and 5 phrases you never want to see in your copy. Then re-run.
Claude is ignoring your playbook file	The playbook was not loaded in the prompt	Explicitly reference the file: "follow the framework in /playbooks/email-frameworks.md for every email you write in this session." Do not assume Claude will find and load it automatically.

API call returning errors	Wrong API key format, wrong endpoint version, or rate limit hit	Ask Claude: "show me the exact request you are sending and the full error response." Then paste the API documentation URL and say "check if the endpoint or format has changed."
CSV output has wrong columns or missing rows	Output format was not specified precisely enough	Always specify: exact column names, what to put when data is missing ("write MISSING not an empty cell"), and whether to include or exclude the header row.
Campaign pushed to sequencer with wrong copy	Auto-accept mode was on, no review step built in	Always add: "before pushing to Instantly, show me the first 3 sequences and wait for my approval." Never push campaigns on auto-accept without a review step.
Scores are inconsistent between runs	Scoring logic is using AI judgement instead of deterministic Python rules	Ask Claude to "write the scoring logic as a Python function with no AI calls inside it. Use only the criteria in CLAUDE.md as if-then rules." Python logic is reproducible. AI scoring is not.

9. Quick Command Reference

Getting started

Command	What it does
npm install -g @anthropic-ai/claude-code	Install Claude Code. Requires Node.js version 18 or above (free to install).
claude	Open an interactive session in your current folder.
claude --resume	Pick up exactly where you left off in your last session.
claude --continue	Resume the last session with all prior context and edits.
claude --dangerously-skip-permissions	Run fully without confirmation prompts. Use in isolated test environments only.

In-session commands

Command	What it does
<code>/clear</code>	Wipe conversation history and start fresh. Same session, empty memory.
<code>/compact</code>	Summarise and compress the session to free up context window space.
<code>/checkpoint</code>	Save a successful API call as a reusable script. Claude never rebuilds it from scratch.
<code>/review</code>	Ask Claude to review everything it just changed.
<code>/help</code>	Show all available commands.

Keyboard shortcuts

Shortcut	What it does
Shift + Tab	Toggle between Plan Mode (think first) and Auto-Accept (execute).
Ctrl + C	Interrupt Claude mid-task cleanly.
Ctrl + C twice	Force-stop a long-running task without closing your session.
Up arrow key	Scroll back through your command history.
Tab	Auto-complete a file path or folder name.

10. Your 30-Day GTM Action Plan

When	Time needed	What to do
Today	10 min	Install VS Code and the Claude Code extension. Log in with your Claude Pro subscription (\$20 per month).
Day 1	20 min	Create your workspace folder. Write your CLAUDE.md file: your ICP, your offer in one sentence, and paste in your best-performing email as a template.
Days 2 to 3	30 min	Record yourself doing one manual GTM task. Ask Claude: "Watch this recording, classify my tasks, and tell me what to automate first."
Week 2	2 hours	Connect your data provider API and your sequencer API. Run Play 1 (Signal-to-Sequence) on a small test list of 20 to 30 companies.

Week 3	1 hour	Build your first playbook file from the workflow that worked best. Share it with your team.
Week 4	1 hour	Set up Play 10 (Campaign Feedback Loop). Every campaign you launch from now automatically improves the next one.
Month 2 onward	Ongoing	Add new signals, connect more tools, and build more playbooks. The more context Claude has about your business, the more autonomous it becomes.

Official documentation

- [Install guide and full documentation.](#)
- [Prompt engineering guide](#)
- [Anthropic MCP servers](#)

How to get internal buy-in

If you need to justify this to your leadership team, here is what works:

- Start with a time-saving argument: pick one repetitive workflow and calculate how many hours per week it takes today. Run it once in Claude Code and show the time saved.
- Show cost per outcome: if a typical campaign setup costs 4 hours of a senior SDR's time, and Claude Code does it in 8 minutes, the ROI is immediate and easy to show.
- Run one play before asking for budget: the fastest way to get buy-in is to produce a result. Run Play 1 on a small list, book a meeting from it, and present the outcome.
- Frame it as leverage, not replacement: the goal is not to reduce headcount. It is to let your existing GTM team operate at 10 times the output without burning out.

Want this running for your team? ❤️

Every workflow in this guide has been built, tested, and refined across 70+ client engagements.

We apply these systems in a modular way (customised to your ICP, your stack, and your motion) which is why we have the **highest client retention** in the market. 🔥

👉 Book a call with the **SalesCaptain** team.

We will map out the 2 to 3 workflows with the highest ROI for your current stage and show you exactly how we would build them.

